GTS+
Data Acquisition

Vehicle Control History, PCS Freeze Frame Data & camera images

Field steps, at the vehicle · Rev. Sept 2026
Global Techstream+ replaced Techstream, which Toyota discontinued in September 2024.

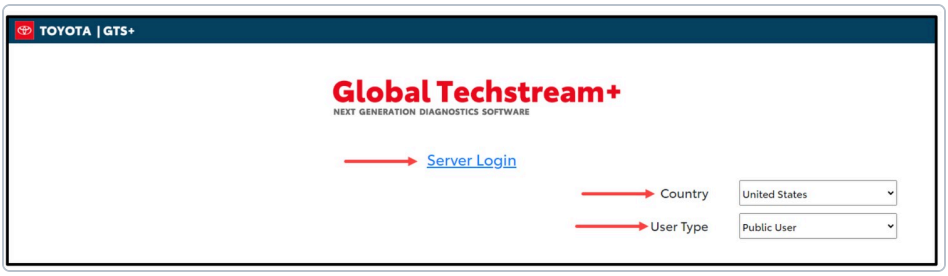
Before you start

- Confirm you have lawful authority. Some states require the owner's written consent.
- Confirm the TIS subscription is active — **Professional Diagnostics**, not Standard.
- **GTS+ needs the internet.** It runs in a browser and logs in to a Toyota server. Offline works for **2 days maximum** after your last online login, then it refuses to start.
- Retrieve early. VCH records overwrite; every key cycle risks losing data.
- Have a booster battery. GTS+ shows vehicle battery voltage in the header — watch it.
- Photograph the vehicle, VIN plate, odometer and DLC. Note laptop clock vs. actual time.
- **Capture every screen as you go** — see step 15 for how, because GTS+ printing is unreliable.

1 Check for **12 volts** at the battery. Turn the ignition **ON** — do not start the engine. Connect the VIM to the PC by USB and to the vehicle's **DLC3 (OBD-II)** port.

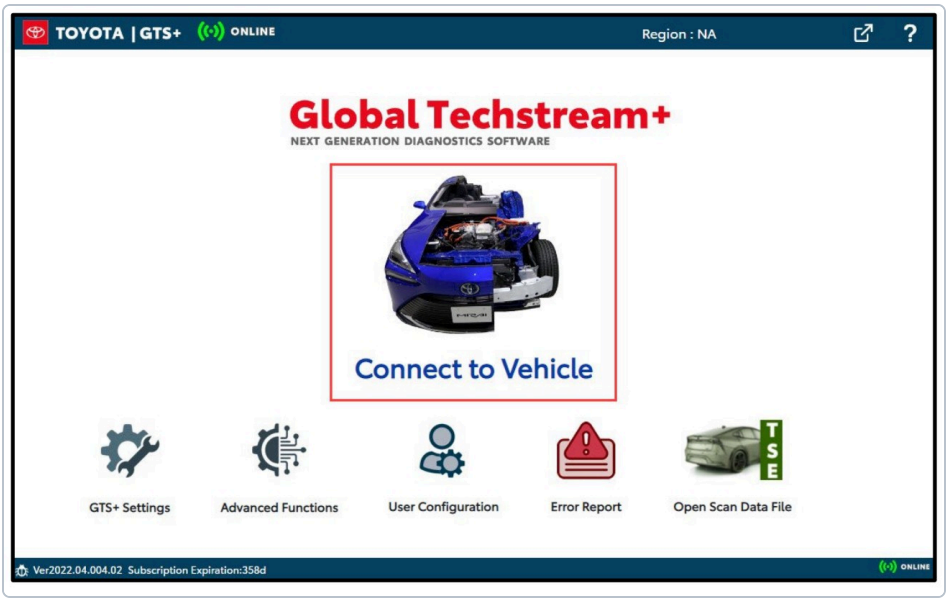
> **Using a CDR 900 as the VIM?** It still works, but you must select it in GTS+ Settings **and enter the serial number of your 900**. Mongoose-Plus MFC3, MongoosePro MFC2 and MongoosePro MFC are the Toyota-supported interfaces.

2 Double-click the **GTSPlus** desktop icon. It opens in your default browser — use Chrome, Edge or Firefox. Set **Country** and **User Type** (Public User), then click **Server Login**.



Step 2 — Country, User Type, Server Login.

3 At the home screen, **capture the bottom status bar** — it shows the GTS+ version, the remaining subscription time and the ONLINE indicator.



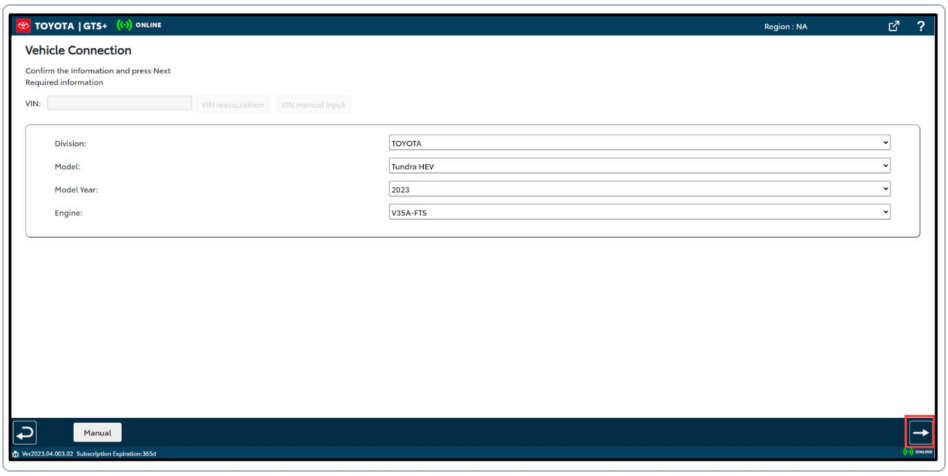
Step 3 — home screen. Version and Subscription Expiration sit in the bottom-left bar.

> **The subscription is a hard deadline.** A retrieved `.vdas` file will not open once it expires. Plan to finish the PCS Data Viewer output while the subscription is still live.

4 Open **GTS+ Settings** (bottom row of the home screen) and confirm the VIM selection, dealer/workshop details and e-mail. Save with the button at the bottom right. Capture the VIM setting.

5 Click **Connect to Vehicle**.

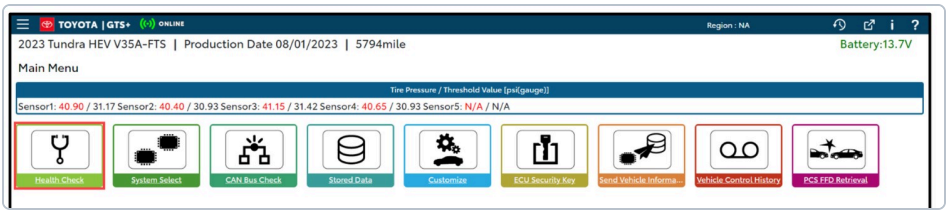
6 On the **Vehicle Connection** screen, confirm the VIN and the Division, Model, Model Year and Engine, choose the vehicle **Option**, then click the arrow to continue. **Capture this screen** — it is your record that the tool was on this VIN.



Step 6 — Vehicle Connection. Note *VIN reacquisition* and *VIN manual input* beside the VIN field, and *Manual* at the bottom left.

> **Connecting manually or direct-to-module? Enter the VIN yourself** using **VIN manual input**. The retrieval file is named from the VIN.

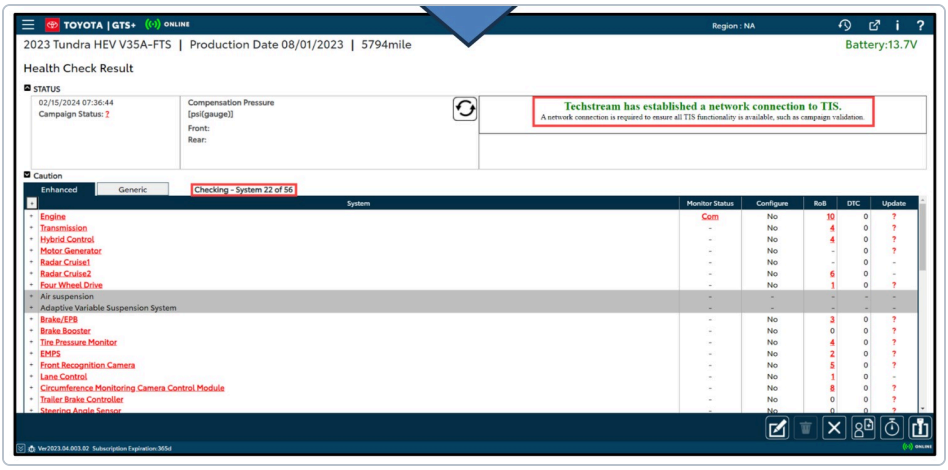
7 The **Main Menu** appears. Capture it: the header carries the model, production date, odometer and battery voltage, and the tile row is your map for the rest of the job.



Step 7 — Main Menu. **Vehicle Control History** and **PCS FFD Retrieval** are the last two tiles on the right.

> **This is the big change from Techstream.** There is no Read Data Function button and no Stored Data tab. VCH and PCS FFD Retrieval are now top-level tiles on the Main Menu.

8 Run **Health Check**. Let it finish scanning every system, then capture the result — it is your ECU inventory, with RoB and DTC counts per system.

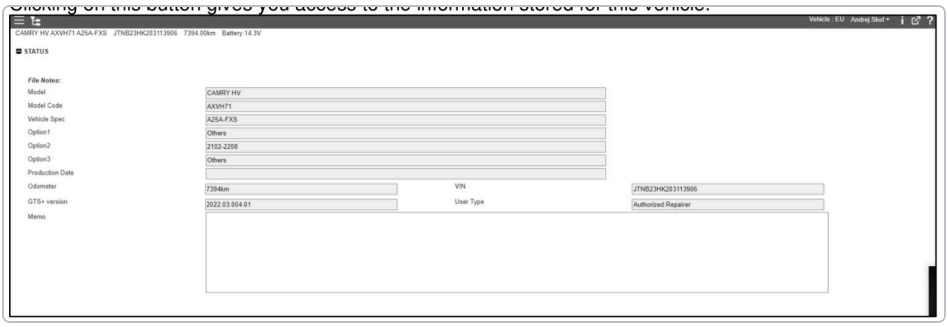


Step 8 — Health Check Result. Open Freeze Frame Details with the snowflake icon under the FFD column on any system with DTCs.

9 Open **System Select**, choose the **SRS Airbag** system, and work the DTC screen and the **Data List**. Use the **SAVE** button at the bottom right — it

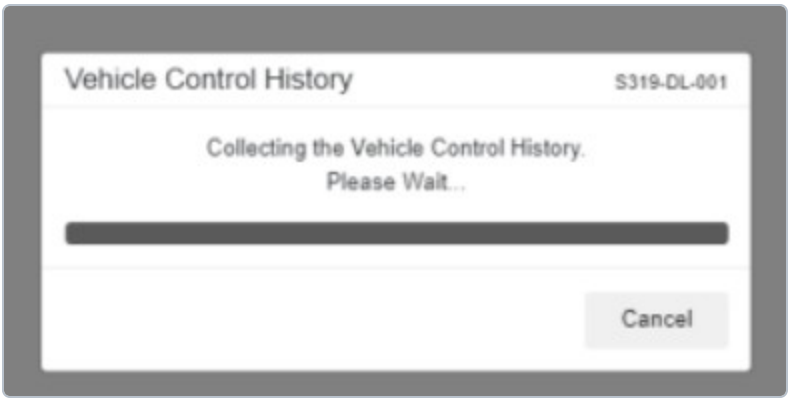
writes the details into the scan data (TSE) file. Capture both screens.

10 Open **Stored Data** and capture it. It records the model, model code, vehicle spec, options, production date, odometer, **the GTS+ version**, the VIN and your user type — the provenance of the whole retrieval.



Step 10 — Stored Data. Put the case number in the **Memo** field before you capture it.

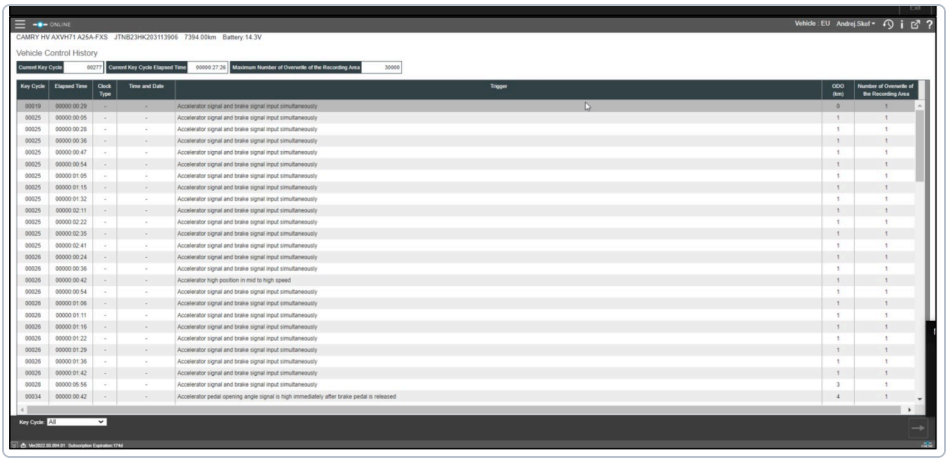
11 Click the **Vehicle Control History** tile. GTS+ collects the history from the airbag ECU.



Step 11 — collection in progress.

12 The event table appears: key cycle, elapsed time, clock type, time and date, trigger, odometer and overwrite count, with the current key cycle and the maximum overwrite count across the top. Use

the **Key Cycle** filter at the bottom to narrow it. Capture the whole table — see step 15.



Step 12 — the VCH event table in GTS+. Pinch to zoom.

> **This tile gives you VCH only — no camera images.**
> Do step 13 as well, even if the table looks complete.

13 Go back to the Main Menu and click **PCS FFD Retrieval**. This is the path that pulls the Vehicle Control History **and** the forward-facing camera images, and writes the `.vdas` retrieval file.

Work the prompts in order and **capture every one**:

- the consent / legal notice — tick OK to continue;
- the processing choice — take **Read data**, not the CSV option, which skips the images;
- the image-category selection — **check every box offered** (five on TSS 2.0 and later, one on TSS 1.0);
- the estimated read time — confirm your power will last, the read can run long;
- the completion summary — it names the file and reports Operation FFD, Image data and

Vehicle Control History separately. **This is the most important capture of the retrieval.**

> **Verify these prompts against the screen in front of you.** The published GTS+ documentation does not yet illustrate the PCS FFD Retrieval prompts; the sequence above is the one Techstream used and is what practitioners report in GTS+. If a prompt differs, capture it and follow what it says.

14 Note where the file landed, from the path the completion screen shows. Retrieval files have historically been written to `C:\Users\Public\Documents\Techstream\PCSdata\`, while GTS+ keeps its own user data in `C:\Users\Public\Documents\GTSPlus\UserData\`. Confirm the actual path on the day — do not assume it.

15 **How to capture screens in GTS+.** Toyota acknowledges printing problems. For **Health Checks and data lists**, the browser's own print (**Ctrl + P**) works. For **DTC, Freeze Frame Data, RoB, VCH and operational history**, use a full-page screenshot browser extension such as GoFullPage, or press **Prt Scn** and paste into Paint (**Ctrl + V**), then save.

> **Budget time for this.** Practitioners moving from Techstream report having to take a screenshot per timestamp where Techstream produced one file with everything in it. Plan for it rather than discovering it at the vehicle.

16 Save the scan data file for the session, then **copy the `.vdas` file, the scan data file and every screen capture to external media.** Open the copies and check their sizes before you disconnect.

17 Work the checklist below. When everything is accounted for, exit GTS+, disconnect the VIM from the DLC3 and switch the ignition off.

Before you leave

Every item below should be in hand. If one is not applicable, write down *why* rather than leaving it blank.

1. Retrieval file `.vdas`

Where: the path shown on the PCS FFD Retrieval completion screen
How: copy to external media — this is the evidence

2. PCS FFD Retrieval completion summary

Where: end of the PCS FFD Retrieval sequence
How: screen capture — status of Operation FFD, Image data and VCH, plus the file name

3. Vehicle Control History event table

Where: Main Menu → Vehicle Control History
How: full-page screen capture (GoFullPage or Prt Scn)

4. Consent notice, processing choice, image categories, estimated time

Where: the PCS FFD Retrieval prompts
How: screen capture, one per prompt

5. Scan data (TSE) file for the session

Where: saved from System Select · How: save + copy to external media

6. GTS+ version & subscription expiration

Where: bottom status bar · How: screen capture

7. VIM selection (and CDR 900 serial, if used)

Where: GTS+ Settings · How: screen capture

8. Vehicle identification and VIN

Where: Vehicle Connection screen · How: screen capture

9. Main Menu header — production date, odometer, battery voltage

Where: Main Menu · How: screen capture

10. Health Check result

Where: Main Menu → Health Check · How: Ctrl + P to PDF + screen capture

11. SRS Airbag DTCs and Data List

Where: System Select → SRS Airbag · How: SAVE to the TSE file + screen capture

12. Stored Data screen with case number in Memo

Where: Main Menu → Stored Data · How: screen capture

13. Scene photographs and clock note

Where: vehicle, VIN plate, odometer, DLC · How: camera / notes

Next, off the vehicle: open the `.vdas` file in **PCS Data Viewer** — it still reads GTS+ retrievals, with the header labelled *File Information when GTS read out PCS Data*. Run **File → Output PCS Data** for the CSV and image output, and **Print → Output** for the PDF report. Do all of it **before the subscription expires.**

Sources

The GTS+ screens in this guide come from Toyota's own documentation and from current practitioner material. There was no GTS+ procedure in the case folder, so these were researched and added to `files/`:

- **Techinfo TS Lite AM Installation Instructions v4.1**, Toyota — launching GTS+, VIM selection, Connect to Vehicle, Vehicle Connection, Main Menu and Health Check screens.
- **GTS+ Independent User Guide**, Toyota — Stored Data and Vehicle Control History screens, offline-mode limit, file locations.
- **Global Techstream Plus Known Bugs V2023.04.003.02**, Toyota — the printing workarounds in step 15.
- **Techinfo TS Lite AM FAQ v4.0**, Toyota — subscription and support.
- **CDR-O October 2025** and **Ruth EDR** decks, already in the folder — Techstream discontinued September 2024, the CDR 900 serial-number requirement, the VDAS-expiry warning, and the screenshot-per-timestamp problem.
- **Accessing Toyota Event / Camera Data**, N. Manz, Toyota Canada (WREX 2023) — VCH is stored in the airbag ECU; PCS data paths.

Brad Muir's *GTS+ User Guide for Distribution* (October 2024) is referenced by the decks in the folder but is not in it, and is only posted behind a paywall. If you can get a copy it is the closest thing to a crash-investigation-specific GTS+ manual, and this guide should be checked against it.